

The Delegation Blueprint

A working document. Fill it in, act on it, and come back to it in three weeks.

What this is

Most people trying to get help start with the task that annoys them most. That task is usually the hardest to explain, so it never actually leaves their plate, and the attempt convinces them delegating does not work.

This document works the other way around. It finds the small, repeatable work that is quietly taking your week, puts it in order, and gives you something you can hand to another person without a long conversation.

How to use it

	Step	Time it takes
1	Fill in the business snapshot. You are marking where things sit today, not where you want them.	10 minutes
2	Pick your first three from the snapshot, using the rule on page 3.	5 minutes
3	Complete the delegation plan for those three. Leave the others blank until later.	20 minutes
4	Write the baseline numbers on the measurement sheet before anything changes.	10 minutes
5	Come back in three weeks and fill in the second column.	10 minutes

One rule before you start

Write what is true rather than what is tidy. A blueprint filled in honestly and acted on beats a perfect one that stays in your downloads folder.

1. Business snapshot

Six categories. For each one, mark where it actually sits today. Be honest rather than generous. Nobody else sees this.

Category	Under control	Manageable	Slipping	Not happening
Inbox and messages Reading, sorting, deciding what needs you, and replying to the ones that do not.				
Calendar and scheduling Booking, rescheduling, reminders, and the back and forth before anything is fixed.				
Money in and out Sending invoices, chasing them, receipts, subscriptions, and expense records.				
Content and posting Publishing what is already written, repurposing it, and keeping to a schedule.				
Following through with people The reply you meant to send, and everything that happens after someone says yes.				
Files, systems and admin Naming, filing, moving the same information between two places, forms and renewals.				

Anything not covered above

2. Choosing your first three

Look at everything you marked Slipping or Not happening. From that list, choose three using the rule below.

The rule

Choose it if	Leave it if
You have done it more than three times this month.	It happens once a quarter.
You could explain it to a competent stranger in under ten minutes.	Explaining it takes longer than doing it.
Getting it wrong is annoying rather than damaging.	Getting it wrong costs you a client or money.
You keep pushing it to tomorrow.	You avoid it because it needs a decision only you can make.

Your first three

Write them in the order you will hand them over. Not the order of how much they irritate you.

	Task	How often it happens
1		
2		
3		

What you are keeping

Name the things that stay with you, so the list has an edge to it. Your actual craft, the first conversation with someone new, pricing, and anything where your judgment is the product.

3. Delegation plan (1 of 2)

Complete this only for the three you chose. Leave the rest blank and come back to them once the first three are running without you.

Inbox and messages

What it looks like now	What good looks like in three weeks
Who does it	First step, and when

Calendar and scheduling

What it looks like now	What good looks like in three weeks
Who does it	First step, and when

Money in and out

What it looks like now	What good looks like in three weeks
Who does it	First step, and when

3. Delegation plan (2 of 2)

Content and posting

What it looks like now	What good looks like in three weeks
Who does it	First step, and when

Following through with people

What it looks like now	What good looks like in three weeks
Who does it	First step, and when

Files, systems and admin

What it looks like now	What good looks like in three weeks
Who does it	First step, and when

4. Who does it

A task without a name against it is a wish. Fill in a name even if the name is a person you have not found yet, and write what that person needs in order to start.

	Task	Person	Hours a week	Start date
1				
2				
3				

What to hand over with each task

- The steps, written while you did it last. Do not tidy them up first.
- What done well looks like. One sentence describing the finish, not the process.
- The one thing that must never happen. Every task has one.
- Who they ask when they are stuck, and how long they should try before asking.

Notes on the handover

5. Measurement sheet

Fill in the left column before anything changes. Write the number even when it is a guess, because a rough number you can compare beats an exact one you never wrote down.

What you are measuring	Today	In three weeks
Hours a week spent on the three tasks		
Days the inbox goes unanswered		
Follow ups sent late, or not at all		
Invoices sent more than three days after the work		
Evenings worked in a normal week		
Your own answer:		
Your own answer:		

How it felt

Numbers miss the part that matters most. Write one line now and one line in three weeks.

Today	In three weeks

6. After three weeks

Come back to this page with the measurement sheet filled in. There are three honest outcomes and all of them are useful.

Outcome	What it means	What to do
It worked	The three tasks are off your plate and the numbers moved.	Choose the next three from the snapshot and repeat. Do not add more than three at a time.
It half worked	One or two moved. The third came back to you.	The one that came back was either too big or missing a standard. Split it smaller, or write what done well looks like, and try it once more.
It did not work	Everything came back.	The tasks were probably chosen by irritation rather than by the rule on page 3. Go back to the snapshot and choose again.

The pattern worth noticing

Work comes back for one of two reasons. Either the task was never properly explained, or the standard was never written down. It is almost never the person.

Before handing anything over again, write one sentence describing what has to be true when the work is right. That single sentence is the difference between somebody doing tasks for you and somebody running a piece of your business.

If you want a hand with it

Reply to the email your receipt came from and tell me what is on your plate. I will tell you what I would move first.

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